

Episode 166: About Apple-Branded Equipment

I missed my manuscript deadline again (sweat). I'm sorry.

As I mentioned briefly last time, I'm participating in Director Ikuhara's new TV series *Mawaru Penguindrum*. With July broadcast start imminent, the workplace has become quite tense in various ways (bitter laugh). Lots to do! But TV series workplaces are fun.

With Director Ikuhara since *Revolutionary Girl Utena* (for *Utena* I was credited as "Kokuon Kunio"). How many years since theatrical *Revolutionary Girl Utena: Adolescence Apocalypse*? 12 years? 13 years? Anyway, it's been quite a while working with Director Ikuhara again.

As always when participating in TV series, when broadcast approaches, feelings naturally get excited. I want to see everyone's reactions soon (laugh).

Besides terrestrial broadcast, it apparently airs on CS and BS too, so it seems viewable nationwide. So everyone, please treat us favourably. Please look forward to it!

Anyway.

This time, about equipment I use.

Currently I'm stationed daily at *Mawaru Penguindrum*'s workplace, Brain's Base studio in Tokyo's Mitaka, bringing my own equipment for work as usual.

Recently keyboard problems worsened, so I bought and replaced it with a new one. Keyboards are consumables. This old keyboard came with (or rather, was bought with) the desktop main unit. It was a keyboard that travelled through quite various works. Because this machine I'm using here at Mitaka studio was first purchased midway through the first work when I participated in the theatrical *Fist of the North Star* trilogy

at Tokyo Movie in Shin-Yakushi. I think it was 2006? The original MacPro type. Yes, I'm a hardcore Mac user (laugh).

Initially I borrowed Tokyo Movie's machines (miraculously, they had Macs!), but they were somewhat underpowered. Particularly for large copyright still work like posters, or continuous Photoshop batch processing of main story cut colouring data - quite overwhelmed and time-consuming. At that time I was juggling with Toei Animation work at Oizumi - daytime → Oizumi, evening ~ morning → Shin-Yakushi lifestyle. So if machine power could reduce work time even slightly, some personal expense and investment was unavoidable. So I bought the new model (at the time) out of pocket(!).

For about 3 years after that, I participated in theatrical *Fist of the North Star* trilogy and pachinko/pachislot *Fist of the North Star* work in between at Shin-Yakushi studio. When somehow finished, I cleared out of Shin-Yakushi studio and brought this equipment to Oizumi. Used it at Toei Animation studio.

Our colour design equipment at Toei Animation was basically hand-me-down machines from photography staff. Though I expected photography machines to be extremely high-powered, these were honestly underpowered too. So "Fine! I'll use my own equipment!"

At Toei, I completed theatrical *Gegege no Kitaro*, *Strong World*, *One Piece Film, Marie & Galie*, and various other works with this machine, then last year brought it here to Brain's Base.

My basic equipment set: desktop MacPro with keyboard, WACOM pen tablet Intuos, two monitors (EIZO 24-inch ColorEdge and 19-inch sub-monitor). Plus A4 scanner, external HDD, and oh yes, uninterruptible power supply (laugh) as needed. Roughly like that. What the heck, tremendous baggage. Writing it out myself, I'm surprised! (laugh)

Conversely, when participating in *Casshern Sins*, I actually equipped the same basic equipment set at Madhouse. After production ended, I temporarily brought it to

Shogakukan Music & Digital Entertainment in Jinbocho for *Gokujiyo! Mecha Mote Committee Chairman*. Then moved it again to Madhouse (Shin-Nakano this time) to complete *The Tatami Galaxy*. And this is also now at Brain's Base. Active for various checks. Incidentally, there's the same set at my home work room, so amazingly 3 sets total. So I'm doing depreciation on tax returns every year (laugh).

Most production companies mainly use Windows equipment, so borrowing equipment at their studios inevitably means Win machines. Moreover, OS and equipment specs vary considerably by model. And what's concerning is monitors. These vary completely by equipment - is the colour I'm seeing now correct? This is actually the biggest stress.

So from the perspective of being able to concentrate on work without stress by unifying the environment I use daily, I necessarily bring my own equipment sets.

Why Mac originally was, as I wrote here before, Director Yamauchi's "missionary work" and Toei's digital environment being Mac, but I can use Windows to some extent. But compatibility is definitely best with Mac. Windows feels rugged and masculine? Mac feels intuitively gentle? Feminine? I'm drawn to Mac (laugh).

However, depending on what direction my work heads, things will probably change in various ways. If heading toward 3DCG, depending on applications used, it would probably be Windows. How is it?

Even so, I think I probably can't separate from this apple-marked equipment.

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